

Smart Save Business Case Document

Executive Summary:

SmartSave targets the growing segment of young professionals struggling with inconsistent saving and poor spending visibility. The app will use AI and automation to simplify money management, offering real-time insights, goal-setting tools, and smart saving triggers. Designed for ease and engagement, it includes features to boost retention and encourage financial discipline. SmartSave aims to increase user conversion and lifetime value by delivering a personalized, intuitive, and habit-forming financial wellness experience.

Problem Statement:

Young professionals are underserved by current financial tools, which often lack the personalization, automation, and actionable guidance needed to support meaningful financial progress. As a result, they face persistent financial challenges:

- **Inconsistent Saving Habits:** Over **60% of Gen Z and Millennials** report difficulty saving money regularly, with many living paycheck to paycheck despite earning incomes (Source: Bankrate, 2023).
- **Limited Spending Visibility:** Nearly **70% of young adults** admit they don't track their daily or weekly expenses, leading to impulsive spending and end-of-month budget surprises (Source: Deloitte Millennial Survey, 2023).
- **Outdated Budgeting Methods:** Traditional tools are seen as too manual or rigid—**58%** of users abandon budgeting apps within the first month due to complexity or lack of relevance (Source: FinTech Futures, 2022).
- **Lack of Actionable Insights:** Most apps provide historical data without personalized recommendations, leaving users overwhelmed instead of empowered—**72%** say they want proactive financial advice, not just data dashboards (Source: EY Global FinTech Adoption Index, 2023).

Business Goals & Objectives:

The Primary objectives of Smart Save project is to Design and deliver the complete business and functional requirements for the SmartSave mobile/web app within 4 weeks, enabling AI-driven spending tracking, budgeting, and automated savings for young professionals.

Business Goals

The business goals for the SmartSave project are:

- **Increase average monthly savings per user by 15% within 6 months** of launching the MVP, by leveraging AI-generated saving nudges and automated rules.
- **Achieve 80% user engagement with spending insights** (e.g., categorized expense charts, notifications) within the first 30 days of app usage, by delivering clear and visual spending summaries.
- **Ensure 60% of users interact with at least one AI-generated financial nudge** (e.g., spend alerts, savings suggestions) within their first 2 weeks of using the app.
- **Reach a 90% user satisfaction rate** during usability testing of the MVP, by designing a secure, intuitive, and user-friendly interface that builds trust and supports ease of navigation.
- **Complete GDPR and relevant financial data compliance requirements by MVP handoff**, ensuring user data is securely handled from the design stage onward.

Proposed Solution:

SmartSave is a mobile and web application designed to simplify and personalize financial management for young professionals, addressing their most common financial challenges through AI-powered automation and intelligent design.

- **Eliminating Financial Blind Spots:**
With **automated spending tracking**, users gain real-time visibility into where their money goes—empowering them to make informed decisions and curb impulsive spending without manual effort.
- **Replacing Rigid Budgets with Smart Planning:**
Traditional budgeting feels time-consuming and unrealistic. SmartSave offers **intelligent, adaptive budgeting tools** that adjust to each user's lifestyle and financial behavior, making planning feel intuitive—not restrictive.
- **Making Saving Effortless and Automatic:**
Many users struggle to build consistent saving habits. SmartSave tackles this with **automated, AI-powered savings features** that move money into savings based on user-set rules and behavioral triggers—no willpower required.
- **Turning Data into Action:**
Rather than overwhelm users with raw numbers, SmartSave provides **AI-generated insights**—smart nudges, spending pattern alerts, and goal reminders—helping users take timely, meaningful financial actions.

- **Building Trust with Every Interaction:**
A **user-centric, secure interface** ensures the experience is not only easy to navigate but also builds long-term trust through transparency, data protection, and thoughtful design.

Scope:

In- Scope:

Feature	Description
AI-Powered Savings Recommendations	Analyzes spending habits to suggest optimal savings strategies.
Budgeting & Goal Tracking	Set monthly budgets and track savings goals (e.g., vacations, emergencies).
Automated & Manual Savings	Users can set their savings to be automatic or manually saved.
Single Bank Account Integration	Link one account for transaction tracking and auto-saving.
Expense Categorization & Insights	Auto-categorizes spending (e.g., food, utilities) with visual reports.
Monthly Savings Challenges	Gamified prompts (e.g., "Save \$50 this week") to motivate users.

AI Chatbot (Basic Support)	Answers FAQs (e.g., "How to adjust budgets?") via text.
Push/Email Notifications	Alerts for goals met, overspending, or tips.
Security (2FA + Encryption)	Protects user data with two-factor auth and bank-grade encryption.
Basic Internal Admin Tool	Internal tool to monitor app performance and user activity.

Out-of-Scope:

Potential future features not included in MVP.

Feature	Description
Multiple Bank Account Linking	Supporting savings/transactions across multiple linked accounts.
Gamification/Rewards System	Points, badges, or cashback for hitting savings milestones.
Payroll Integration	Direct savings deductions from employer payroll systems.

Business Account Features	Tools for small businesses to manage company savings.
Multi-Currency/Forex Support	Saving or converting funds across foreign currencies.
Group/Peer Savings Goals	Shared savings pools for families/friends (e.g., joint trips).
Voice Assistant Capabilities	Voice-controlled savings via Alexa/Google Assistant.
Advanced Financial Reports	Exportable PDF/CSV reports for taxes or accountants.

Stakeholders:

Stakeholder	Role	Interest	Influence
Product Owner/Coordinator	Defines vision and prioritizes requirements	High	High
Lead BA / Coordinator	Project Lead	High	High
Business Analyst Team	Elicits requirements, documents needs	High	High
Legal Advisors	Ensure regulatory and data compliance	Medium	Medium
Tech Vendors / API Partners	Provide APIs and technical integrations	Medium	Medium
Developers / Engineering Team	Build and implement the solution	High	High
UI/UX Designers	Design the app interface and user experience	High	Medium

Marketing Team	Drive product awareness and adoption	High	Medium
Young Professional Users	Primary end users	High	Medium
QA/Testers	Validate product quality and functionality	Medium	Medium
Finance Team	Monitor budget and financial returns	Medium	Medium
Customer Support Team	Handle post-launch issues and feedback	Medium	Low

Cost & Benefits Analysis:

Cost Category	Details
Development Cost	- UI/UX - Backend & Frontend Development - App Testing & QA
Technology Cost	- Cloud hosting - Database Management - AI Integration
Staffing Cost	- Business Analyst - Project Manager - Developer - Quality Assurance Tester
Marketing Cost	- Pre-Launch Awareness - Social Media Advertisement - Influencer-Partnership
App Maintenance Cost	- App Maintenance - Regular Updates & Patches

Total Estimated Costs (6 months post-launch): ~~₦15M~~ – ~~₦20M~~

Benefits Category	Details
User Acquisition Potential	10,000+ downloads in first year via partnership with influencers
Revenue Streams	- Freemium model with premium features (budgeting, AI insights) - Affiliate products (insurance, investment tools) - Ad placements
User Retention	Smart recommendations encourage daily/weekly use, driving long-term engagement
Social Impact	- Increased financial literacy - Reduced debt burden among young users

	- Improved savings habits
Brand Positioning	Early mover advantage amongst Gen-Z/Millennial fintech savings niche

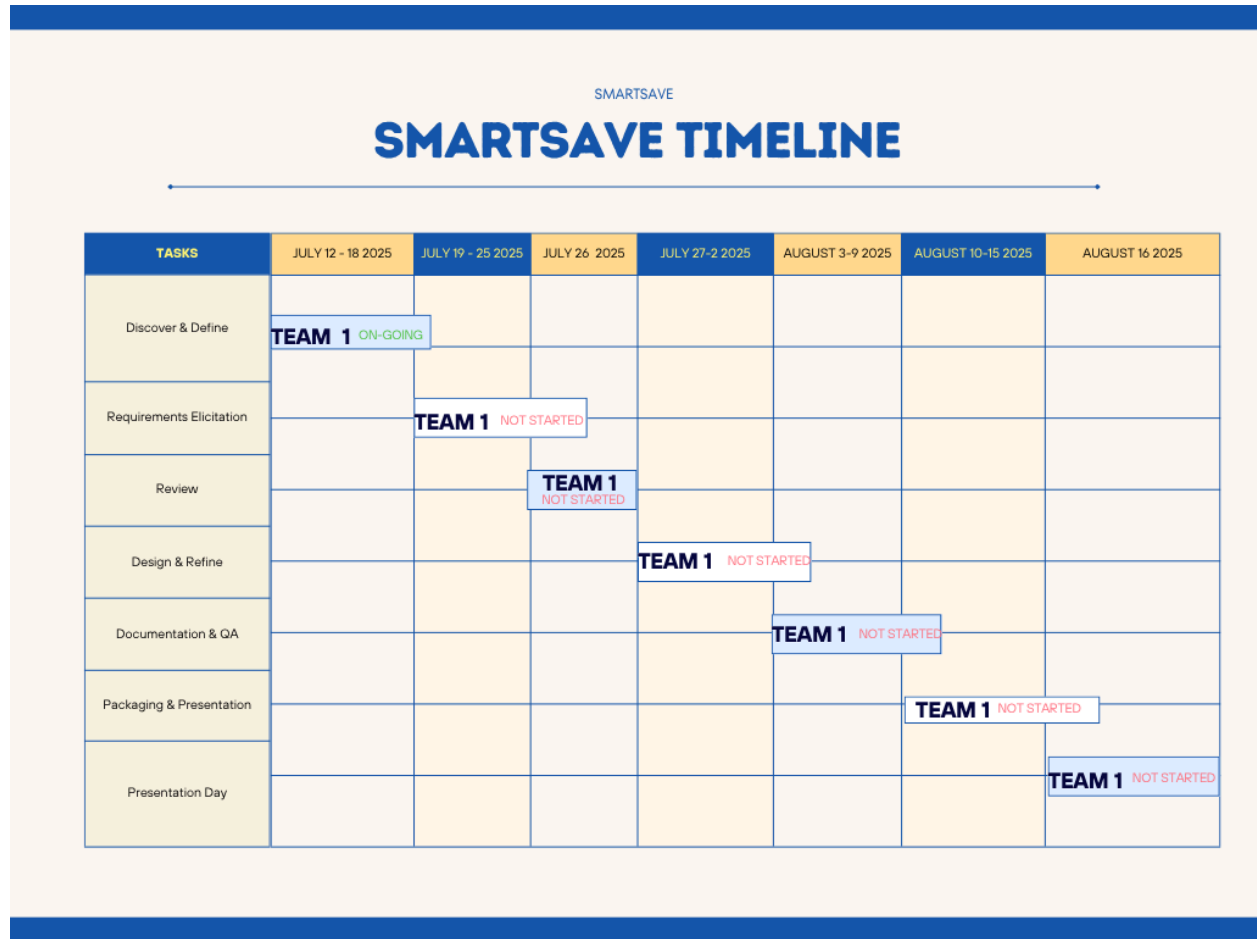
Estimated ROI (Year 1) is likely to be 35% – 50%, scaling to 70%+ in Year 2 with market growth.

Risk Analysis:

Risk ID	Risk	Likelihood	Rating	Impact	Rating	Mitigation Strategy
RK 01	User Trust & Data Privacy Concerns	High	High	High	High	- Implement end-to-end encryption, clear privacy policies, and regular audits. - Implement bank-grade encryption, two-factor authentication, and transparent data policies.
RK 02	Low User Adoption Post-Launch	Medium	High	High	High	- Partner with influencers, targeted onboarding, and gamified engagement. - Run targeted marketing campaigns, offer referral rewards.
RK 03	Regulatory Compliance (CBN Guidelines)	Medium	High	Medium	High	- Engage a legal advisor; maintain regular updates with regulators. - Hire a compliance consultant, subscribe to CBN Newsletter and stay updated on FinTech laws.

RK 04	AI Insight Inaccuracy or Bias	Low	Medium	High	Medium	- Continuously train AI models using local user data and feedback loops. - Use transparent algorithms, allow manual override, and conduct local user testing cycles.
RK 05	Technical Downtime/Failures	Low	High	Medium	High	- Ensure cloud-based redundancy, rigorous testing, and 24/7 tech support. - Host on reputable cloud providers, monitor app performance, and establish incident protocols.
RK 06	Cybersecurity Breach	Low	High	High	Medium	- Invest in secure architecture, regular penetration tests, and multi-factor authentication. - Conduct quarterly vulnerability assessments and adopt security best practices.
RK 07	Inflation/Economic Volatility	High	Medium	Medium	High	- Price flexibility in subscriptions. - Localize cost structure, and diversify revenue streams.

Timeline :



WEEK	PHASE	FOCUS	ACTIVITIES	KEY OUTPUT
Week 1 (July 12 – 18, 2025)	Discover & Define	Understanding the problem	- Project kickoff section. - Define Roles - Produce Business Case	- Research summary - Stakeholder Map - Business Case
Week 2 (July 19 – 25, 2025)	Requirements Elicitation	Elicit & prioritize requirements	- Draft user stories with acceptance criteria. - Conduct MoSCoW prioritization - Create BRD - Write business and functional requirements.	- BRD - MoSCoW - User Stories
Midpoint Check-In (July 26, 2025)	Review	Validate Direction	- Present BRD & stories. - Share personas - Gather feedback from mentors. - Re-validate scope & MVP focus.	- Midpoint Deck - Feedback Notes
Week 3 (July 27 – August 2, 2025)	Design & Refine	Visualize & Improve solution	- Update BRD - Create low fidelity wireframes. - Map “TO-BE” process flow - Update user stories based on feedback	- BRD - Miro Prototype or Wireframes. - Refined Process Diagrams.
Week 4 (August 3 – 9, 2025)	Documentation & QA	Finalize analysis	- Write risk register - Complete acceptance criteria - Build traceability matrix - Internal peer QA review	- Final BRD - Acceptance Criteria Sheet - Risk Register - Traceability Matrix
Week 5 (August 10 – 15, 2025)	Packaging & Presentation	Prepare for demo	- Consolidate documents - Build final presentation deck - Team dry run	- Final Pitch Deck - BA Project Package
Final Day (August 16, 2025)	Presentation Day	Deliver the project	- Submit final docs - Present to Product Owner.	- Certificate - Final feedback sheet

Recommendation:

1. Start with the User, Always.

- Conduct continuous user research and usability testing to ensure the app meets real-world financial habits.
- Validate assumptions early to refine features and boost adoption.

2. Build Smart: MVP First, Extras Features Later

- Launch with essential features (budgeting, savings automation, insights) to deliver quick value.
- Save advanced features (gamification, investments) for future updates based on user feedback.

3. Secure & Compliant by Design

- Treat security as non-negotiable—implement strong encryption and GDPR/NDPR compliance from day one.
- Ensure transparent data policies and secure API integrations to protect sensitive financial data.

4. Integrate AI Cautiously

- Use AI-driven insights ethically—prioritize transparency, user consent, and accuracy.
- Build trust by avoiding over-automation and letting users control their experience.

5. Speed Up Development with FinTech Partnerships

- Integrate trusted APIs instead of building from scratch.
- Reduce costs, accelerate launch timelines, and ensure reliable banking data access.

6. Agile Execution with Clear Goals

- Adopt iterative development (sprints, MoSCoW prioritization) to adapt quickly.
- Keep documentation (BRD, user flows) flexible to accommodate new insights.

7. Keep Stakeholders Aligned & Engaged

- Maintain open communication through regular updates and feedback loops.
- Early involvement prevents misalignment and reduces costly rework.

8. Measure What Matters for Growth.

- Define success metrics upfront (retention rates, savings goals, engagement).
- Use data-driven insights to refine the app post-launch.